Yanqi Li

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EDUCATION

Ph.D., Consumer Sciences, The Ohio State University Expected May 2027
Minor: Economics
Dissertation: three essays on China's "Later, Longer, Fewer" campaign and family outcomes
Committee: Tansel Yilmazer (advisor), Drew Hanks, Lauren Jones, Dean Lillard

M.S., Economics, University of Wisconsin–Madison 2022

B.A., Economics, Northwest University, China 2020

RESEARCH FIELDS

Policy Evaluation, Aging, Childcare, Population Economics, Intergenerational Support

JOB MARKET PAPER

How Reduced Fertility Shaped Grandparental Childcare: Evidence from China's "Later, Longer, Fewer" Campaign

Does having fewer children and grandchildren change how much grandparents care about their grandchildren? I study China's "Later, Longer, Fewer" (LLF) campaign of the 1970s, which sharply reduced fertility before the One-Child Policy. Using variation in campaign intensity across provinces and birth cohorts and four waves of the China Health and Retirement Longitudinal Study (CHARLS, 2011–2018), I find that women more exposed to the campaign had fewer children and fewer grandchildren, yet were more likely to care for their grandchildren. One unit of exposure raises the probability of providing grandchild care by 2.4 percentage points (6 percent of the mean). The effect works through whether grandmothers provide care at the extensive margin rather than through hours. It runs through sons' children and is largest in families whose first child, or first two children, are sons. Consistent with Becker–Barro altruism, the results show that fertility restrictions shape intergenerational support across three generations.

WORKING PAPERS

How Reduced Fertility Affects Eldercare Received in Old Age: Evidence from China's "Later, Longer, Fewer" Campaign (with Tansel Yilmazer and Lauren Jones)

We study how reduced fertility affects old-age support, using China's "Later, Longer, Fewer" (LLF) campaign of the 1970s as a source of exogenous variation in family size. Individuals with greater LLF exposure have fewer children, which may reduce the eldercare they receive later in life. Using province-by-cohort variation in campaign intensity and three waves of the China Health and Retirement Longitudinal Study (2013–2018), we find that the LLF campaign reduced the eldercare parents receive, especially fathers. Because eldercare questions are asked only of respondents who report ADL/IADL limitations, we address sample selection using Lee bounds.

WORK IN PROGRESS

Wage Rates, Childcare Costs, and Grandmothers' Labor Market Outcomes (with Lauren Jones and Tansel Yilmazer)

This paper examines how the birth of a grandchild affects grandmothers' labor supply, and how childcare prices and the wages of mothers and grandmothers jointly shape household time allocation between childcare

and market work. The paper uses the genealogical structure of the Panel Study of Income Dynamics (PSID) and an event-study design around the birth of the first grandchild.

How the Age Gap between Spouses Shapes Mortality (with Tansel Yilmazer and Lauren Jones)

This paper examines how the age gap between spouses relates to mortality and the mechanisms through health status and health behaviors. It uses China Health and Retirement Longitudinal Study (CHARLS) microdata and survival analysis, and addresses sample selection by including spouses who died before the survey baseline.

The Effect of China's "Later, Longer, Fewer" Campaign on Human Capital Accumulation (with Lauren Jones and Tansel Yilmazer)

This paper examines how the LLF campaign affected the educational attainment of the exposed generation, using CHARLS microdata and a cohort-based event-study design.

PRESENTATIONS

American Council on Consumer Interests (ACCI) 2023 Annual Conference — May 2023

"The Relationship between Health and Financial Strain" (pooled Survey of Consumer Finances data; instrumental-variables design)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Dr. Tansel Yilmazer, The Ohio State University — 2023–2024

Research Assistant to Dr. Yang Wang, University of Wisconsin–Madison — 2021–2022

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

The Ohio State University

CSCFFS 2260: Healthy Finances and Economic Wellbeing for Individuals and Families

Co-instructor — Autumn 2026

Instructor (Autumn 2024, 55 students; Spring 2025, 25 students) — 2024–2025

Teaching Assistant — 2023–2024

As instructor: delivered lectures on saving, investing, debt, insurance, and taxes; taught time-value-of-money analysis, the interpretation of economic indicators, and behavioral biases in financial decisions; held office hours and provided individual feedback.

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

Dissertation Fellowship — 2025–2026

Graduate Fellowship — 2022–2023

SKILLS

Software: Stata; R and Python (basic)

Data: China Health and Retirement Longitudinal Study (CHARLS), Panel Study of Income Dynamics (PSID), Survey of Consumer Finances (SCF), Current Population Survey (CPS), China Family Panel Studies (CFPS)